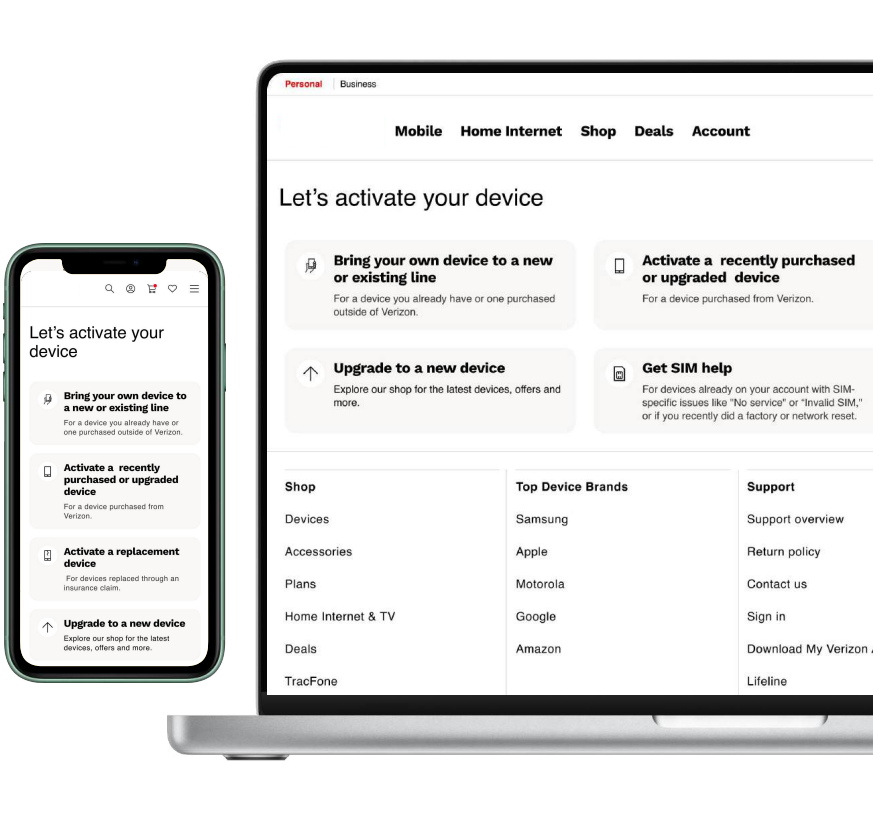
Mobile Quick Activation

Digital Channel Experience

UX Case Study

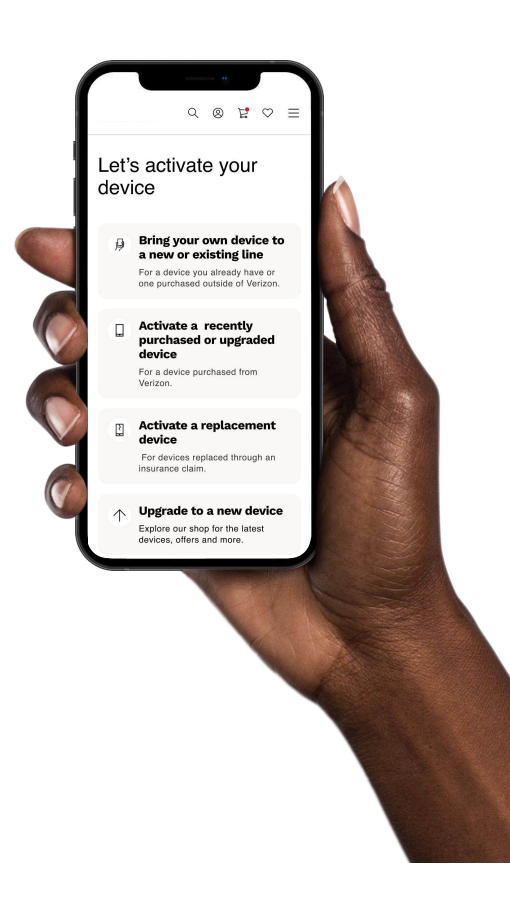
Balaji K


Personal
Business
Mobile
Home Internet
Shop
Deals
Account
Let's activate your device
Bring your own device to a new or existing line
Activate a recently purchased or upgraded device
Upgrade to a new device
Get SIM help
Activate a replacement device

Duration: Nov 07, 2025 - Jul 25, 2026

Introduction

Customers will be proactively guided to a seamless activation flow that uses minimal steps and customer-friendly language, and personalized guidance to confidently activate a device on their account.

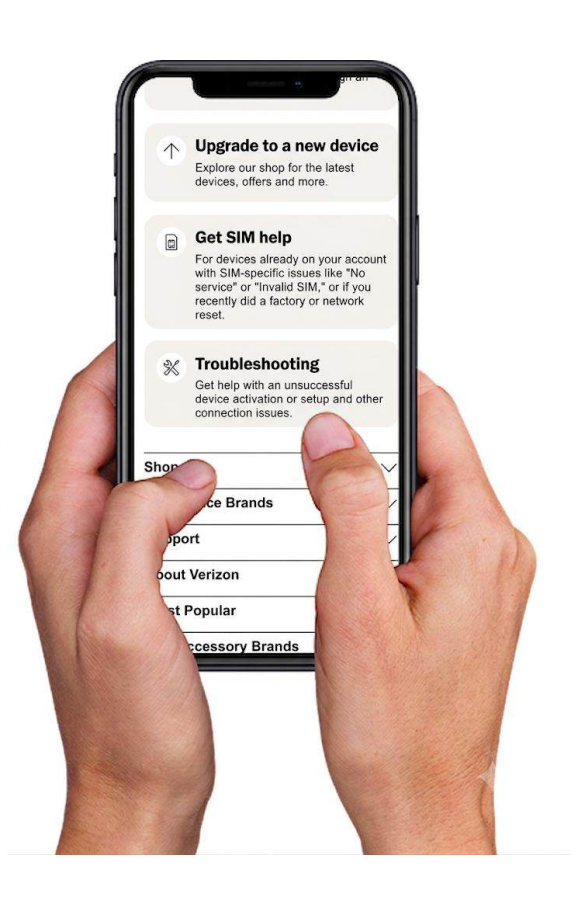


Responsibility

– Two UX Designers

Tools

– Figma
– Gemini


Upgrade to a new device
Get SIM help
Troubleshooting

Problem Statement

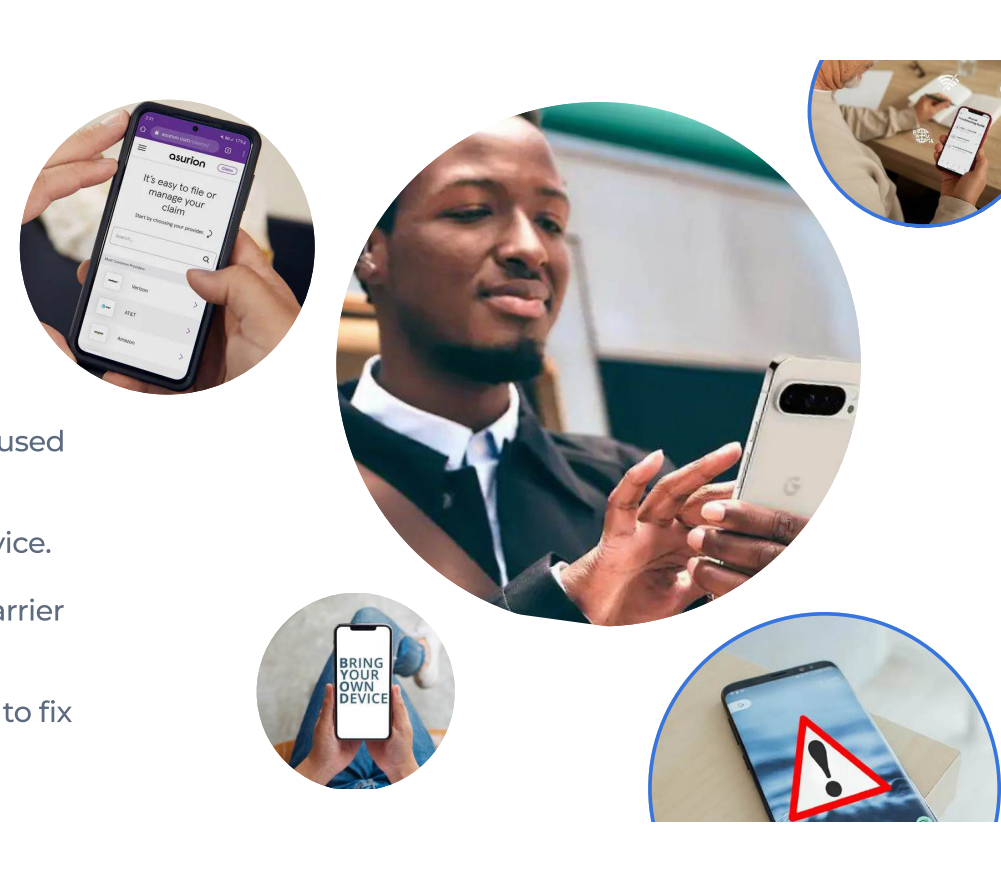
As a customer setting up my device, I need a clear, intuitive path to activate my SIM without decoding technical jargon, and I need real-time updates on my activation status, so that I can get connected quickly and confidently without needing to contact support.

Goals

To accelerate customer time-to-value by replacing a fragmented setup process with a guided, frictionless workflow. By removing dead ends and irrelevant paths, we will empower users to successfully activate their devices on their own, simultaneously improving the customer experience and reducing reliance on call center support.

Design Process

Discovery	Define	Ideate	Design	Test
User Research Competitve Analysis	User Personas User Journey	User Flow Information Architecture	Wireframe Hi-Fi Designs Prototype	Feedbacks Conclusion



Target Audience

Upgraders: Transferring a number to a new or used phone.

Insurance Claim: Activating a replacement device.

BYOD Setup: Activating a new SIM for a non-carrier device.

Troubleshooting: Resetting or changing a SIM to fix connectivity.

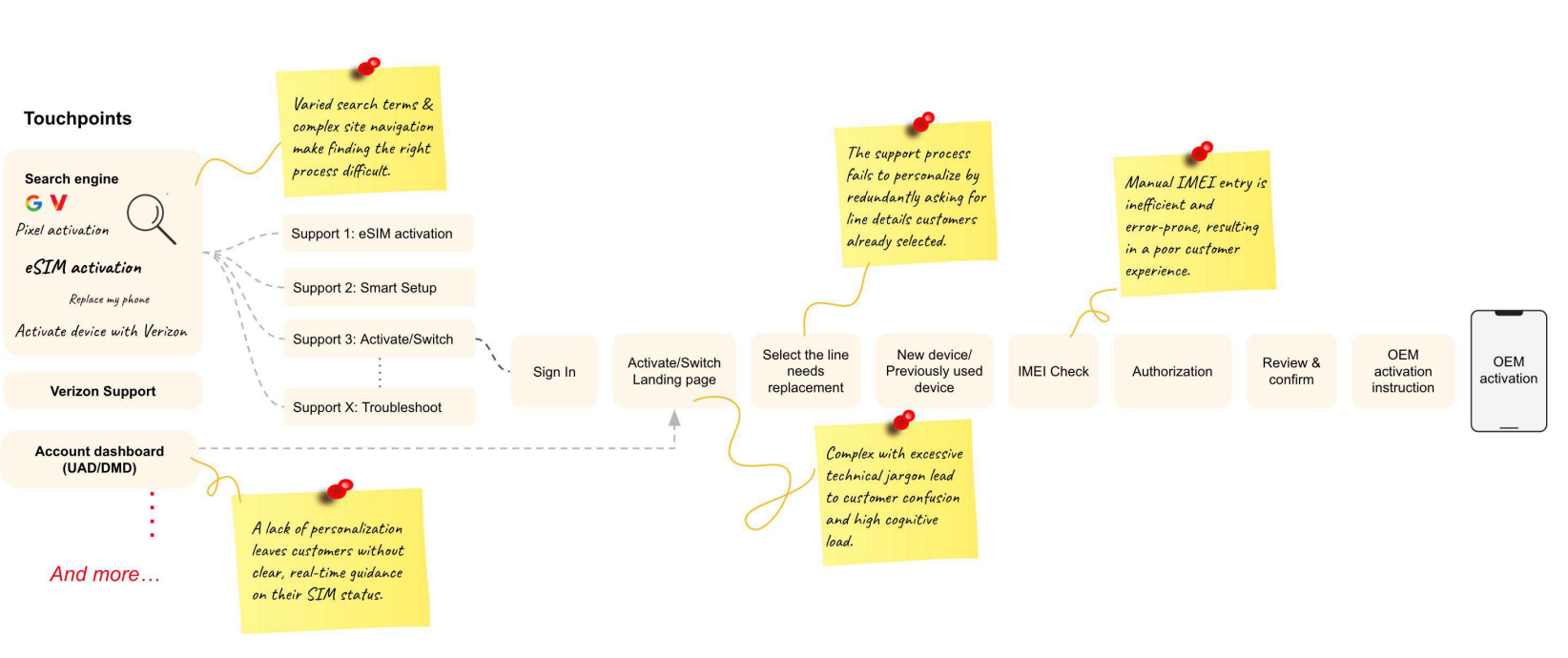
User Research

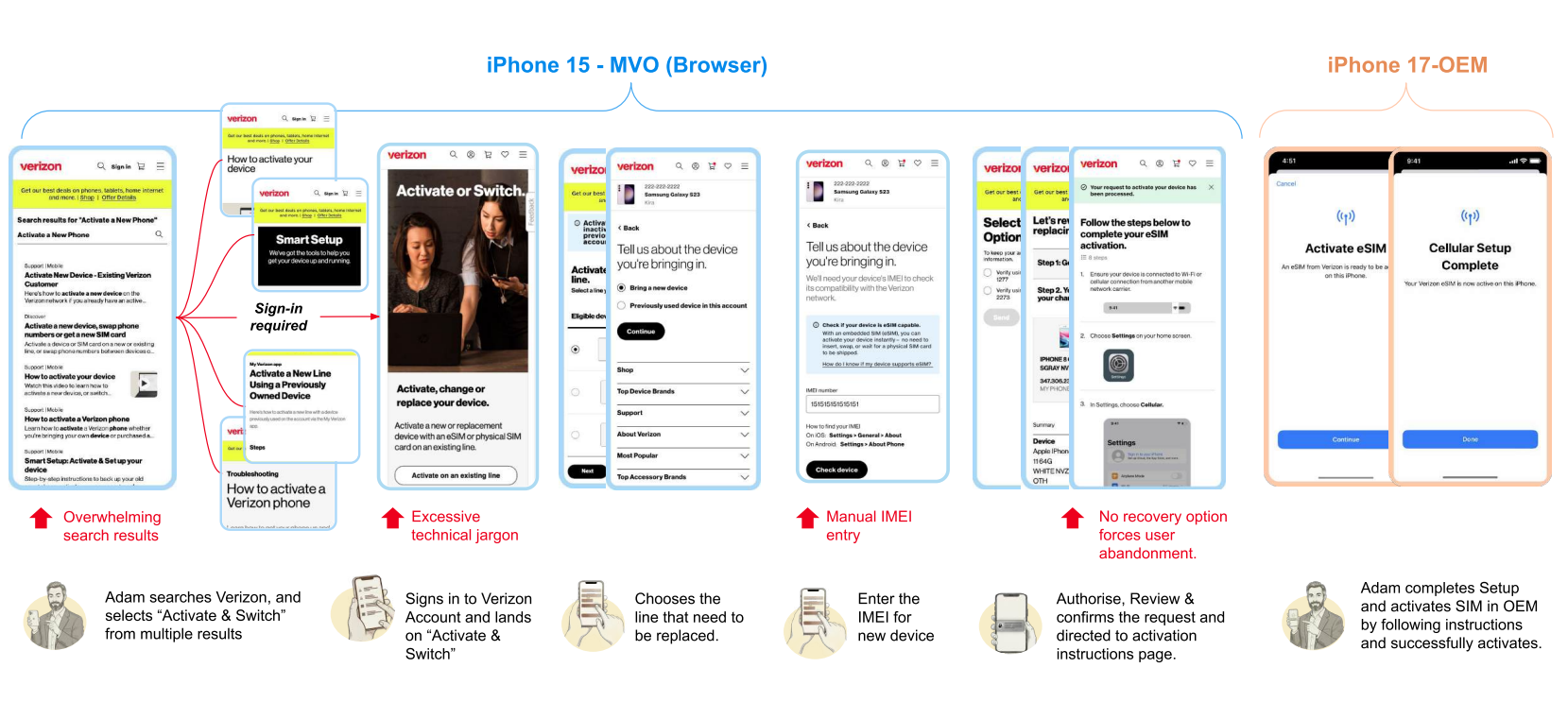
Customers require a fast, autonomous self-service experience to manage their mobile connectivity without needing to call a customer support representative. Whether they are swapping an existing number to a newly acquired device, activating an Asurion replacement phone, or changing a SIM card to troubleshoot a connection issue, users need an intuitive, seamless pathway to complete these tasks quickly and independently.

Metrics from CMI report (Dec 2024 - Sep 2025)

Device Activation Completions & Failures	**3.6M** Activations	**202K** Failures	**5.6%** Failure Rate
Activation Call-in Rate	**42.4%** BYOD Sim	**17.3%** Activate/SIM Swap	

Current state - User flow


Touchpoints
Search engine
Pixel activation
eSIM activation
Replace my phone
Activate device with Verizon
Verizon Support
Account dashboard (UAD/DMD)
And more…
Varied search terms & complex site navigation make finding the right process difficult.
Support 1: eSIM activation
Support 2: Smart Setup
Support 3: Activate/Switch
Support X: Troubleshoot
Sign In
Activate/Switch Landing page
Select the line needs replacement
New device/ Previously used device
IMEI Check
Authorization
Review & confirm
OEM activation instruction
OEM activation
The support process fails to personalize by redundantly asking for line details customers already selected.
Manual IMEI entry is inefficient and error-prone, resulting in a poor customer experience.
Complex with excessive technical jargon lead to customer confusion and high cognitive load.
A lack of personalization leaves customers without clear, real-time guidance on their SIM status.


iPhone 15 - MVO (Browser)
iPhone 17-OEM
Overwhelming search results
Excessive technical jargon
Manual IMEI entry
No recovery option forces user abandonment.
Activate eSIM
Cellular Setup Complete

Adam searches Verizon, and selects "Activate & Switch" from multiple results

Signs in to Verizon Account and lands on "Activate & Switch"

Chooses the line that need to be replaced.

Enter the IMEI for new device

Authorise, Review & confirms the request and directed to activation instructions page.

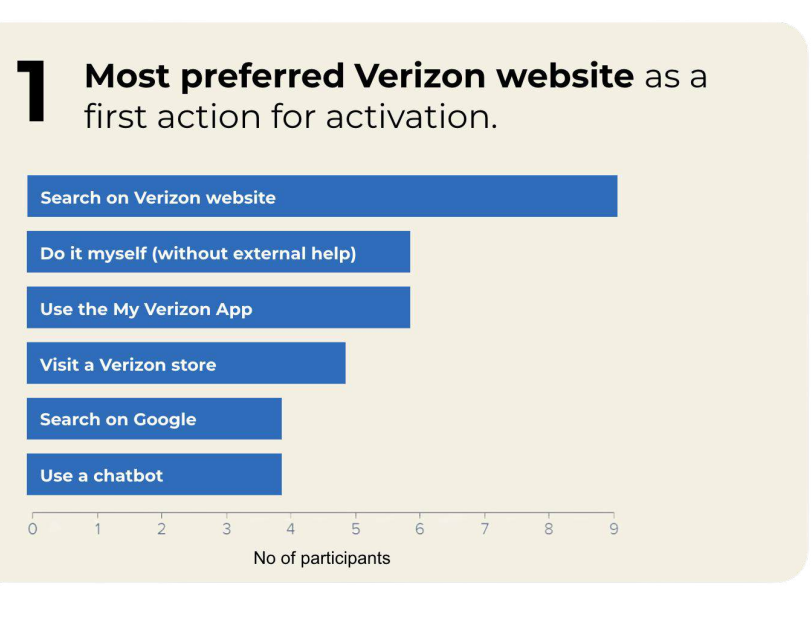
Adam completes Setup and activates SIM in OEM by following instructions and successfully activates.

Spot test analysis on current experience

Key Insights Comprehensive Analysis: Verizon Device Activation

The analysis provided a complete view of activation, revealing key customer behaviors, challenges, and support preferences.

1 **Most preferred Verizon website** as a first action for activation.



2 **Most participants found the search function overwhelming** due to the volume of information returned.

3 **Out of 12 participants, only 2 successfully navigated** to the correct activation path.

Competitive Analysis

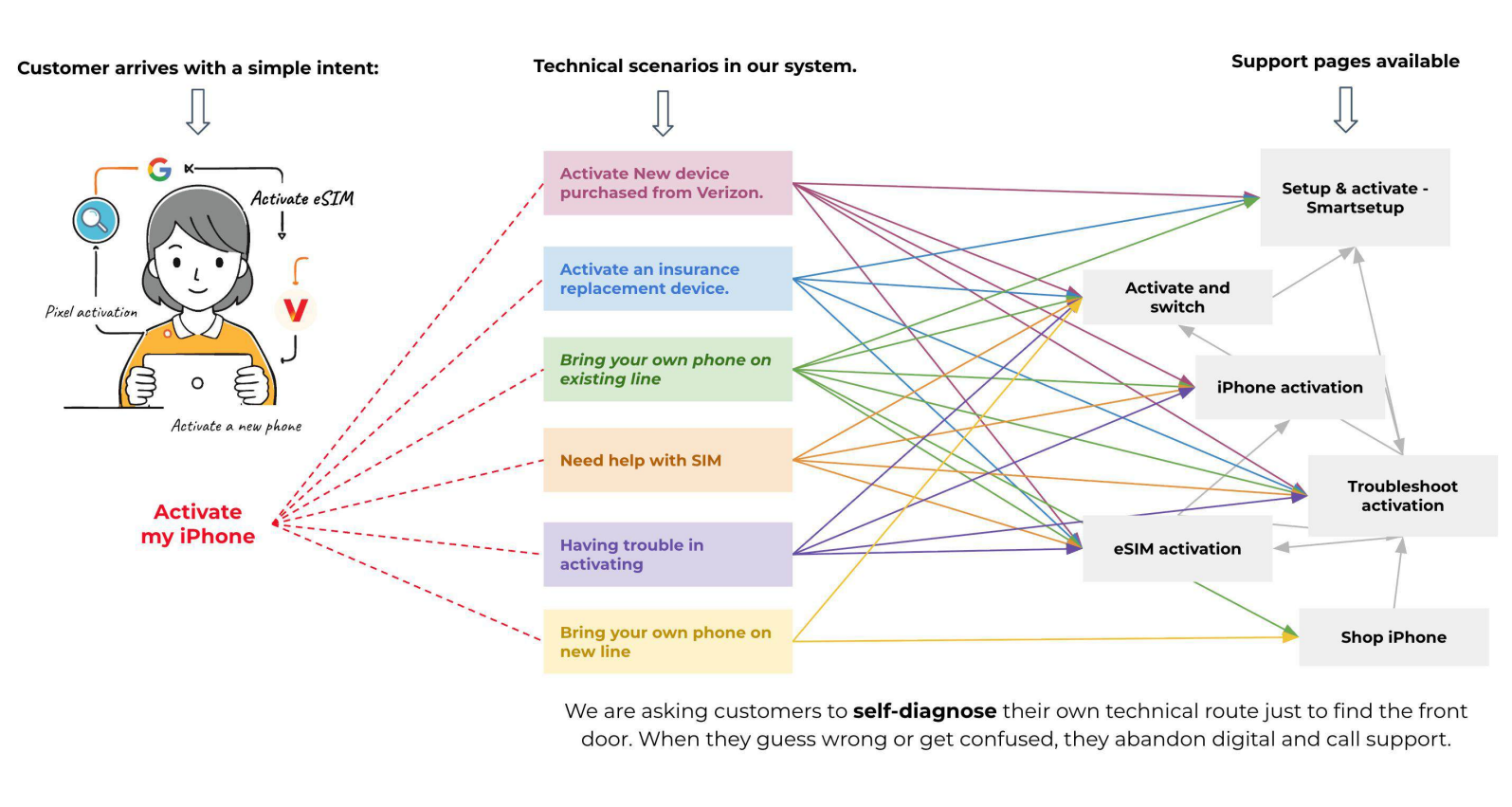
Comparing the eSIM activation process across leading Carriers

Activation type	Verizon	T-Mobile	AT&T	Travel Provider (Airalo, Holafly, Truphone)
App Activation (In-App Provisioning) One-tap install inside carrier apps; uses system APIs to auto-read device identifiers (Make & Model) for zero-input activation.	✓	✓	✓	✓
Carrier Push (POA - Power On Activation) Zero-Touch and typically occurs when you buy a device from the carrier. it triggers the "Carrier Plan Ready to be Installed" notification during new phone setup.	✓	✓	✓	NA
Manual Entry A fallback method requiring the user to manually type-in server and activation codes.	✓	✓	✓	✓
QR Code Activation Manual camera-driven flow to "pull" a profile; mandatory for legacy hardware and travel-based inventory models on web checkouts.	✓ Mandatory for **iPhone 11 and older.**	✓ Generic QR code string.	✓ Physical retail QR kits for iPhone 12 and older devices.	✓ Universal primary method for web checkouts.
Universal Link (Web-to-OEM) A clickable URL from a browser or SMS or email that passes activation tokens directly to the device's native OS installer.	✓ Free Trial web portal for iPhone (iOS 17.4+).	Unverified	Unverified	✓ Utilized in order confirmation emails for 1-tap installation.
App Clip or Instant Apps Lightweight app snippet (<15MB) for instant 5G trials or retail unboxings without a full App Store download.	Unverified	Unverified	Unverified	Unverified
OEM-to-OEM Transfer (Quick Transfer) Enables direct, QR-free migration between devices via Wi-Fi and Bluetooth. This OS-level process bypasses carrier steps and completes in under five minutes.	✓	✓	✓	NA

Competitive Matrix Experience Feature

Feature/ Experience	Telecommunication						Smart Home Appliances		
	Verizon	T-Mobile	AT&T	Xfinity	Telstra	Vodafone	iRobot	SONOS	Nanit Crib Monitor
Pre-Activation Setup Checklist (Guided prerequisites)	✗	✓	✓	✓	✓	✗	✓	✓	✓
Zero Upsell Friction	✗	✓	Unverified	✗	Unverified	✓	✓	✓	✗
Upfront Native OS eSIM Transfer Support (e.g. Apple Quick Transfer)	✗	✓	✗	✓	✓	✓	N/A	N/A	N/A
Step Breakdown with Progress Indicators	✗	✓	✗	✗	✗	✓	✓	✓	✓
Temporary Service for Activation	✗	✗	✗	✗	✓	✗	✓	✓	✗
True Single-Device Activation MVO (No secondary screen for QR)	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	✓	✓	✓
Contextual Troubleshooting & Device State Personalization	✗	✓	Unverified	Unverified	Unverified	Unverified	✓	✓	✓
Visual Clues & Hardware Imagery Confirmation	✗	✓	✗	✗	✗	✓	✓	✓	✓
Unified Multi-Device Provisioning (Single flow for multiple)	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	✓	✗
Activation through App Promoted on Web Support	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓

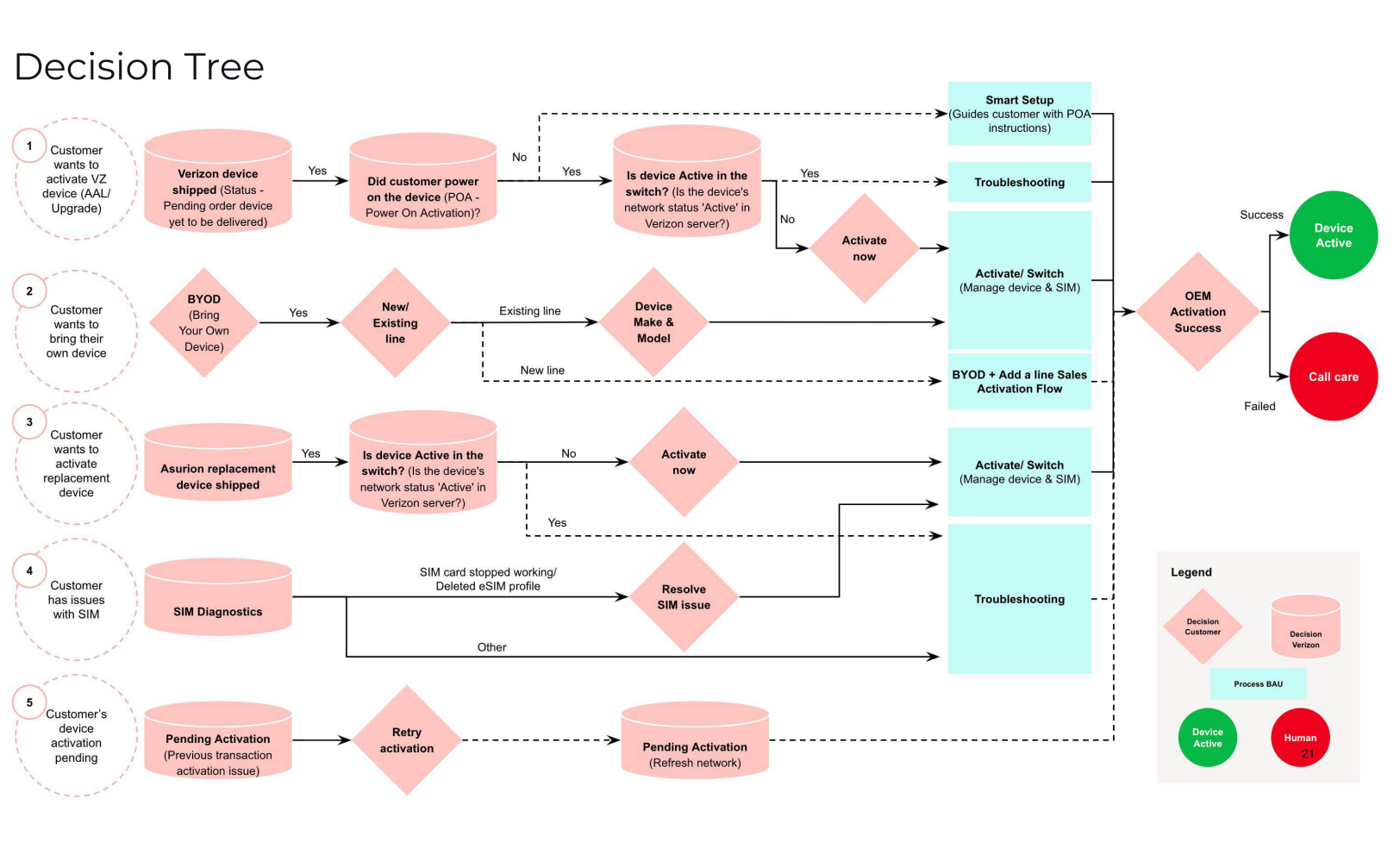
Significant customer frustration


Customer arrives with a simple intent:
Technical scenarios in our system.
Support pages available
Activate eSIM
Pixel activation
Activate a new phone
Activate my iPhone
Activate New device purchased from Verizon.
Activate an insurance replacement device.
Bring your own phone on existing line
Need help with SIM
Having trouble in activating
Bring your own phone on new line
Setup & activate - Smartsetup
Activate and switch
iPhone activation
Troubleshoot activation
eSIM activation
Shop iPhone

We are asking customers to **self-diagnose** their own technical route just to find the front door. When they guess wrong or get confused, they abandon digital and call support.

How we solving for it?

Decision Tree


1
Customer wants to activate VZ device (AAL/ Upgrade)
Verizon device shipped (Status - Pending order device yet to be delivered)
Yes
Did customer power on the device (POA - Power On Activation)?
No
Yes
Is device Active in the switch? (Is the device's network status 'Active' in Verizon server?)
Yes
No
Activate now
Smart Setup (Guides customer with POA instructions)
Troubleshooting
Activate/ Switch (Manage device & SIM)
BYOD + Add a line Sales Activation Flow
OEM Activation Success
Success
Device Active
Failed
Call care
2
Customer wants to bring their own device
BYOD (Bring Your Own Device)
New/ Existing line
Existing line
New line
Device Make & Model
3
Customer wants to activate replacement device
Asurion replacement device shipped
Is device Active in the switch? (Is the device's network status 'Active' in Verizon server?)
No
Activate now
Yes
4
Customer has issues with SIM
SIM Diagnostics
SIM card stopped working/ Deleted eSIM profile
Resolve SIM issue
Other
Troubleshooting
5
Customer's device activation pending
Pending Activation (Previous transaction activation issue)
Retry activation
Pending Activation (Refresh network)
Legend
Decision Customer
Decision Verizon
Process BAU
Device Active
Human

User Persona

❝I'd like to activate the iPhone 17, I bought from Apple store, on my current line.❞

Sidney

IT Professional

Sidney (38 yrs) is comfortable with technology but prefers simple and straightforward solutions when activating his new iPhone. He's looking for clear, concise instructions to get his device up and running without any unnecessary complications.

Account Owner | **Not MVA user** | **Registered digital user**

Personality

Self-service — Dependent

TechSavvy — Limited

Demographics
Age: 38 years

Carrier
2 yrs with Verizon

3
Mobile lines

Line details
iPhone 15 - 111-111-1111

Plan
Unlimited Plus (eSIM)

Situation

I am attempting to activate an iPhone 17 Pro Max(from Apple store) on my current line.

I am browsing on my iPhone to figure out "how to activate my new device" on the Verizon website.

User Flow

BAU | Activation (BYOD on Existing line) - MVO/MVA

Scenario 1: "Customer wants to activate a device they are bringing, on their current line"

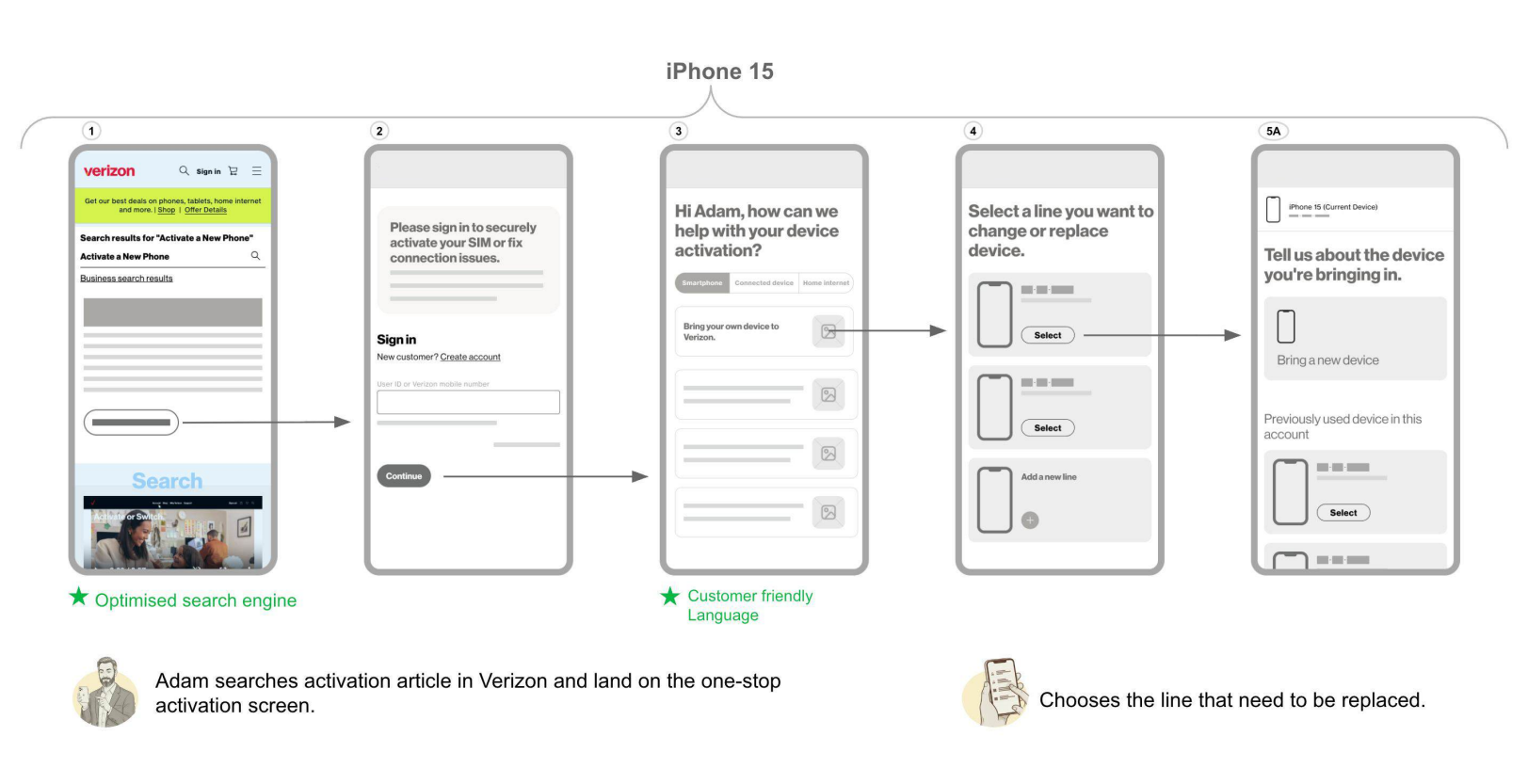
VZ Search / Google Search → Sign In → Select line → Replacing device info → IMEI check → Authorisation → Device protection → Review page → Instructions page → OEM screens → Device activated

Low-fidelity Wireframes

Proposed | Quick Activation (BYOD)

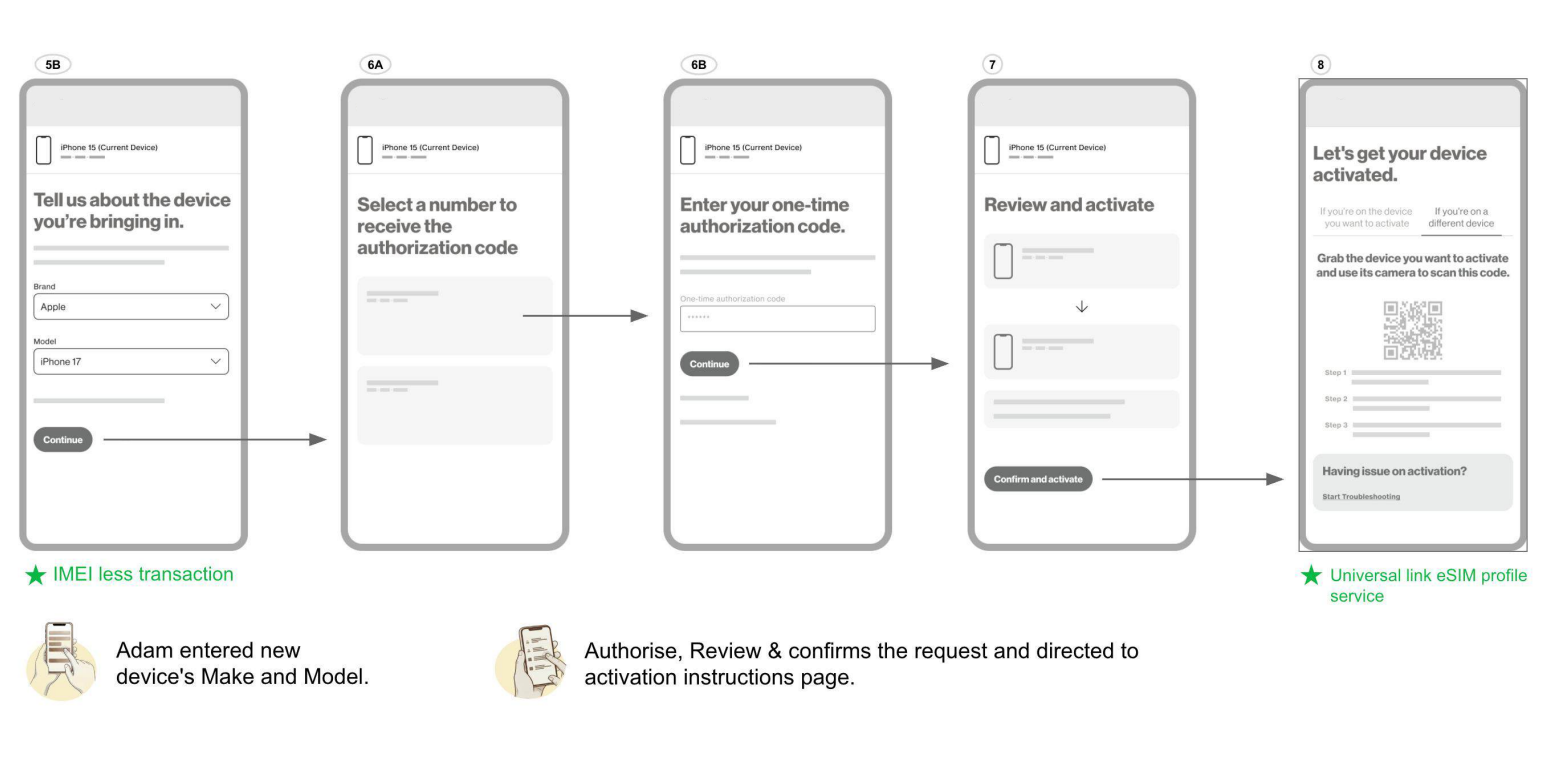
Scenario: "I'd like to activate the iPhone 17 Pro Max, brought from Apple store, on my current line."

(Using different device to browse)


iPhone 15
verizon
Search
Please sign in to securely activate your SIM or fix connection issues.
Sign in
Hi Adam, how can we help with your device activation?
Select a line you want to change or replace device.
Tell us about the device you're bringing in.
Optimised search engine
Customer friendly Language

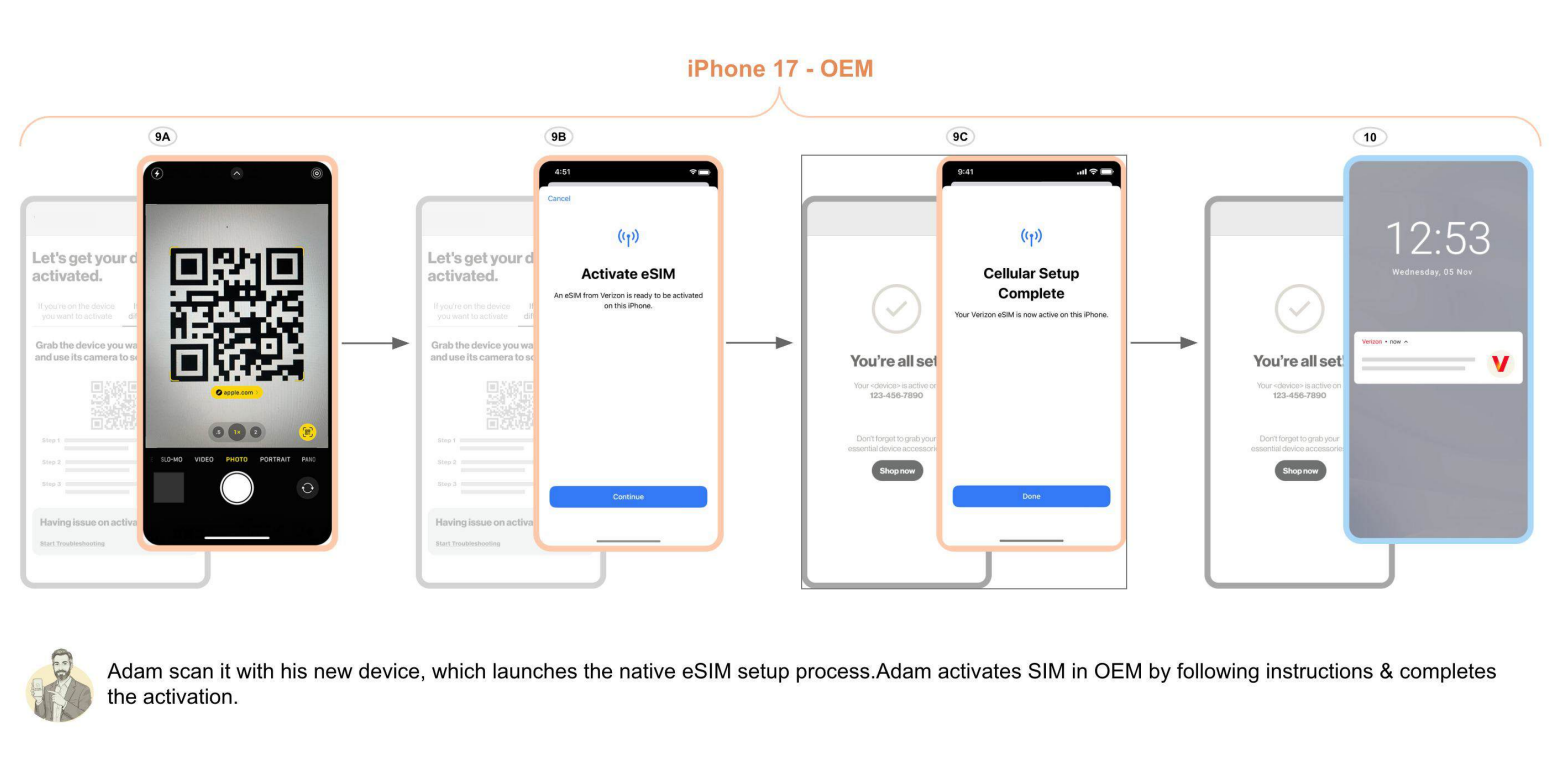
Adam searches activation article in Verizon and land on the one-stop activation screen.

Chooses the line that need to be replaced.


Tell us about the device you're bringing in.
Select a number to receive the authorization code
Enter your one-time authorization code.
Review and activate
Let's get your device activated.
IMEI less transaction
Universal link eSIM profile service

Adam entered new device's Make and Model.

Authorise, Review & confirms the request and directed to activation instructions page.


iPhone 17 - OEM
Let's get your device activated.
Activate eSIM
Cellular Setup Complete
You're all set
12:53

Adam scan it with his new device, which launches the native eSIM setup process.Adam activates SIM in OEM by following instructions & completes the activation.

Huddle in the flow 😨

eSIM isn't tied to a specific device, the activation QR code used to transfer the eSIM can be scanned by any device or intercepted by automated remote servers.

Security concerns

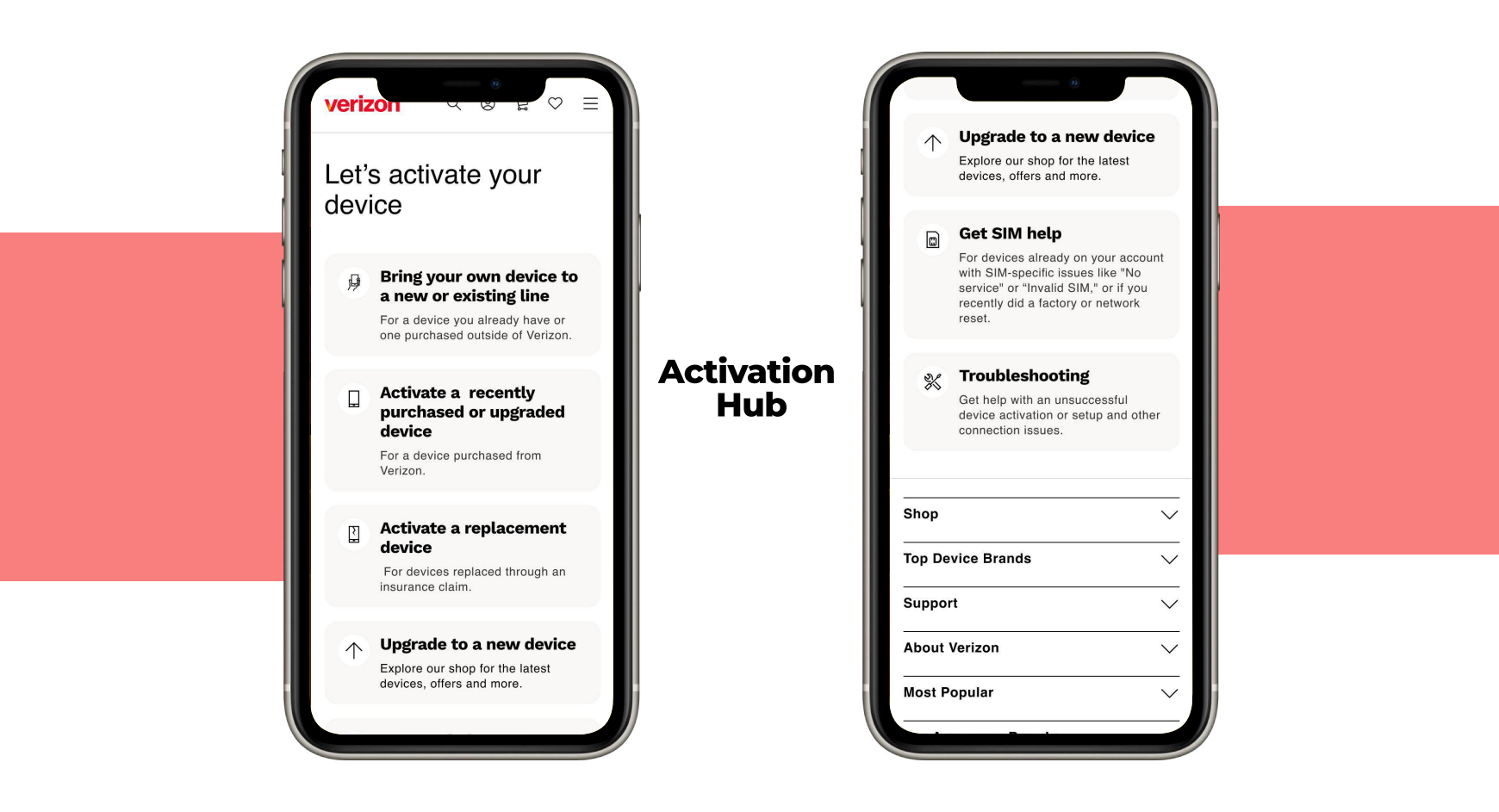
Activation Hub → Select line on account → Enter new device details → Step up authenticate → Review → Activate unmapped eSIM through QR code.

How are we solving? 🙂

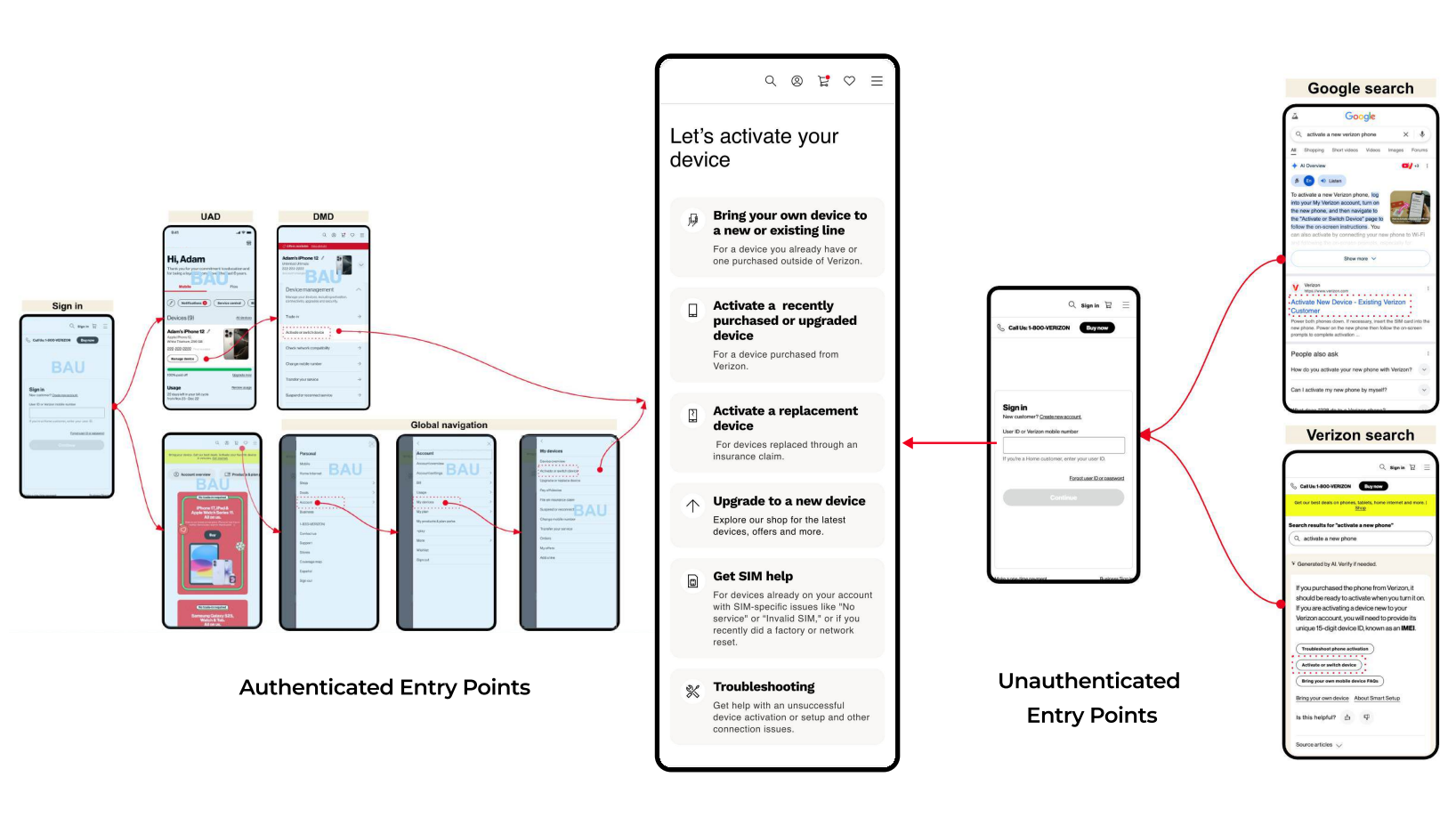
Activation Hub → Select line on account → IMEI fetch & mapping through App Clip/ Websheet → Step up authenticate → Review → Activate

App Clip/ Websheet allows you to securely retrieve the device's hardware identity (IMEI) instantly without forcing the user to manually hunt for it in settings or complete a full app download.

High Fidelity Screen


verizon
Let's activate your device
Bring your own device to a new or existing line
Activate a recently purchased or upgraded device
Activate a replacement device
Upgrade to a new device
Get SIM help
Troubleshooting
Shop
Top Device Brands
Support
About Verizon
Most Popular

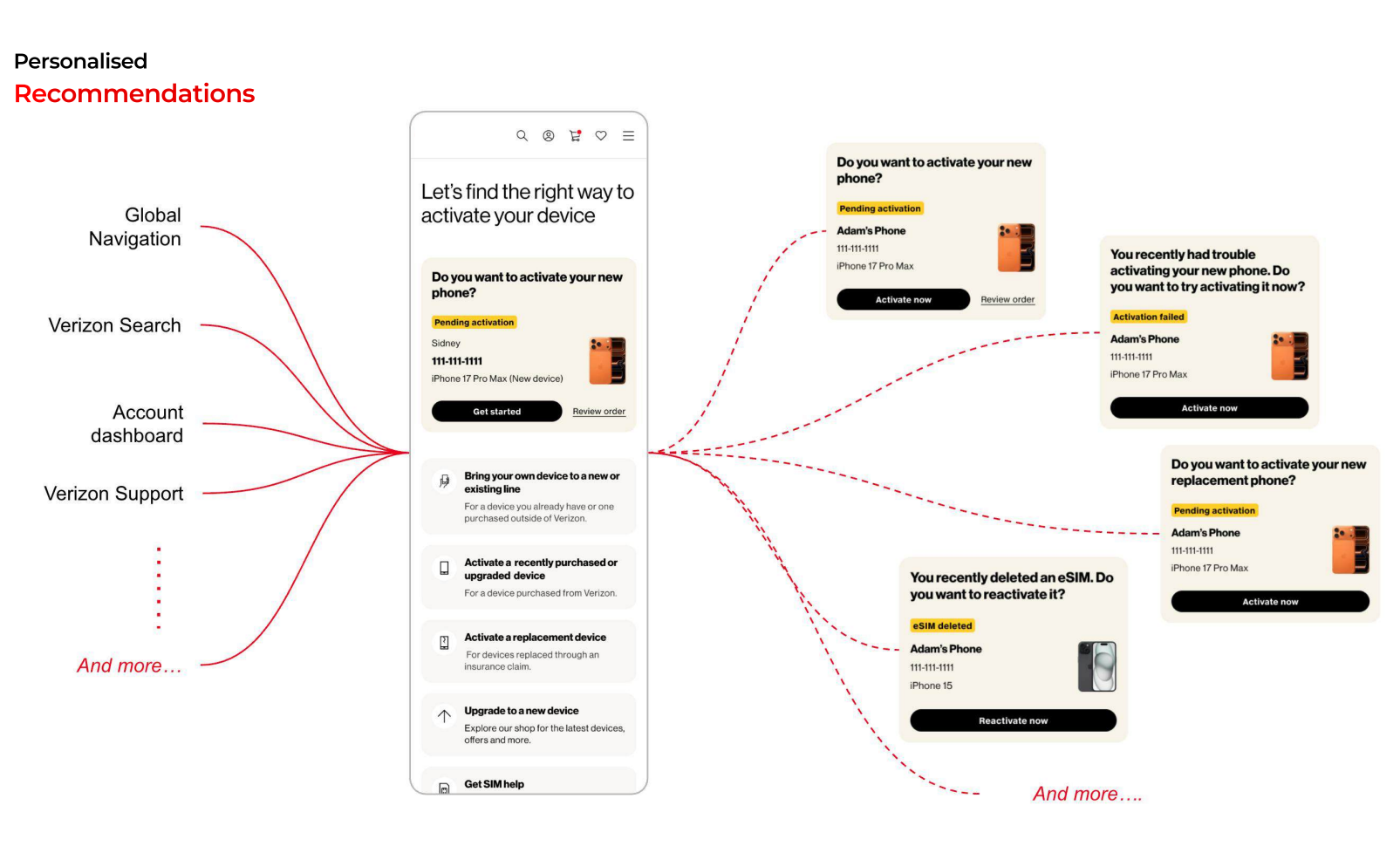
Activation Hub


Sign in
Global navigation
Let's activate your device
Google search
Verizon search

Authenticated Entry Points

Unauthenticated Entry Points

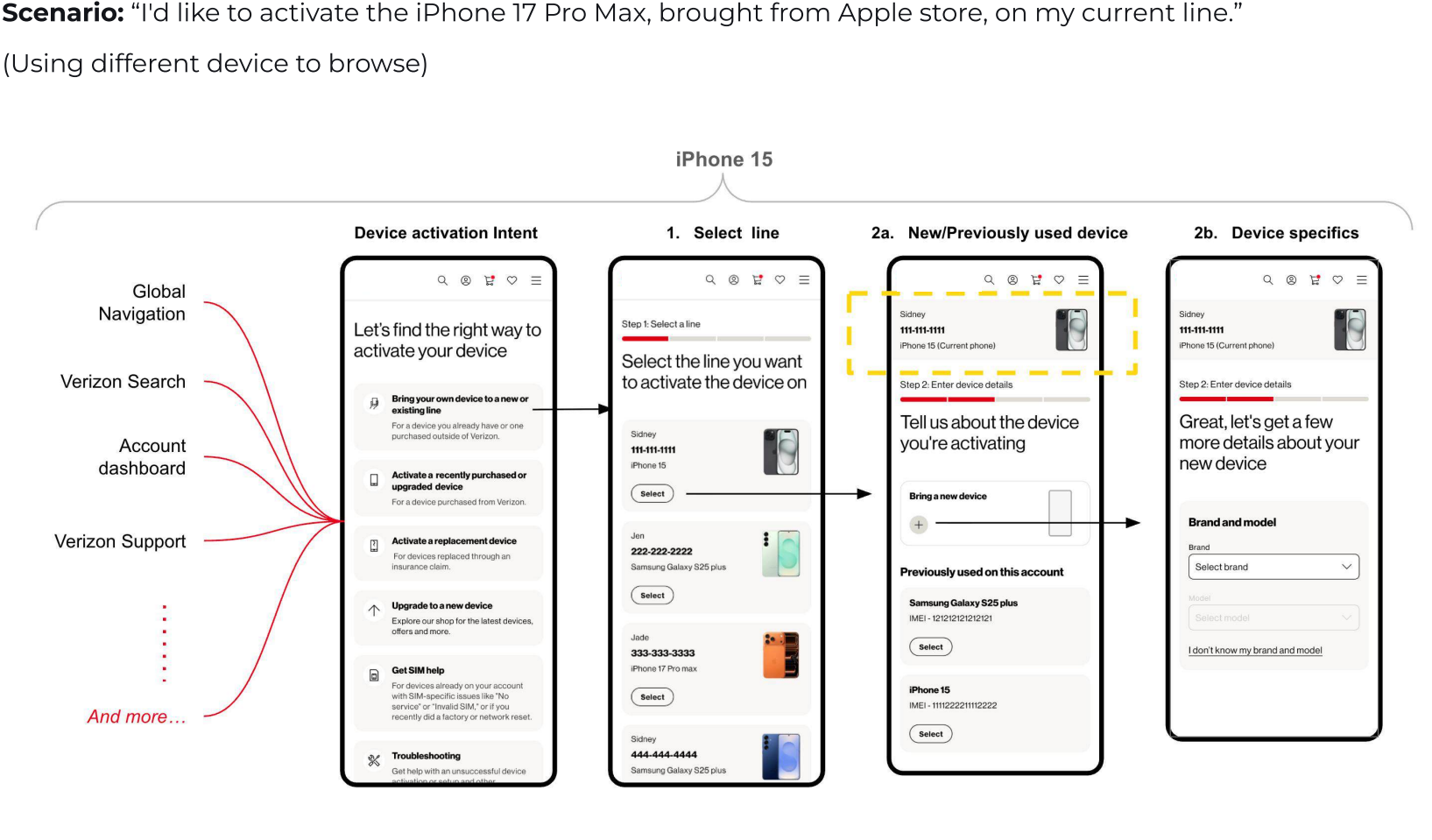
Personalised
Recommendations

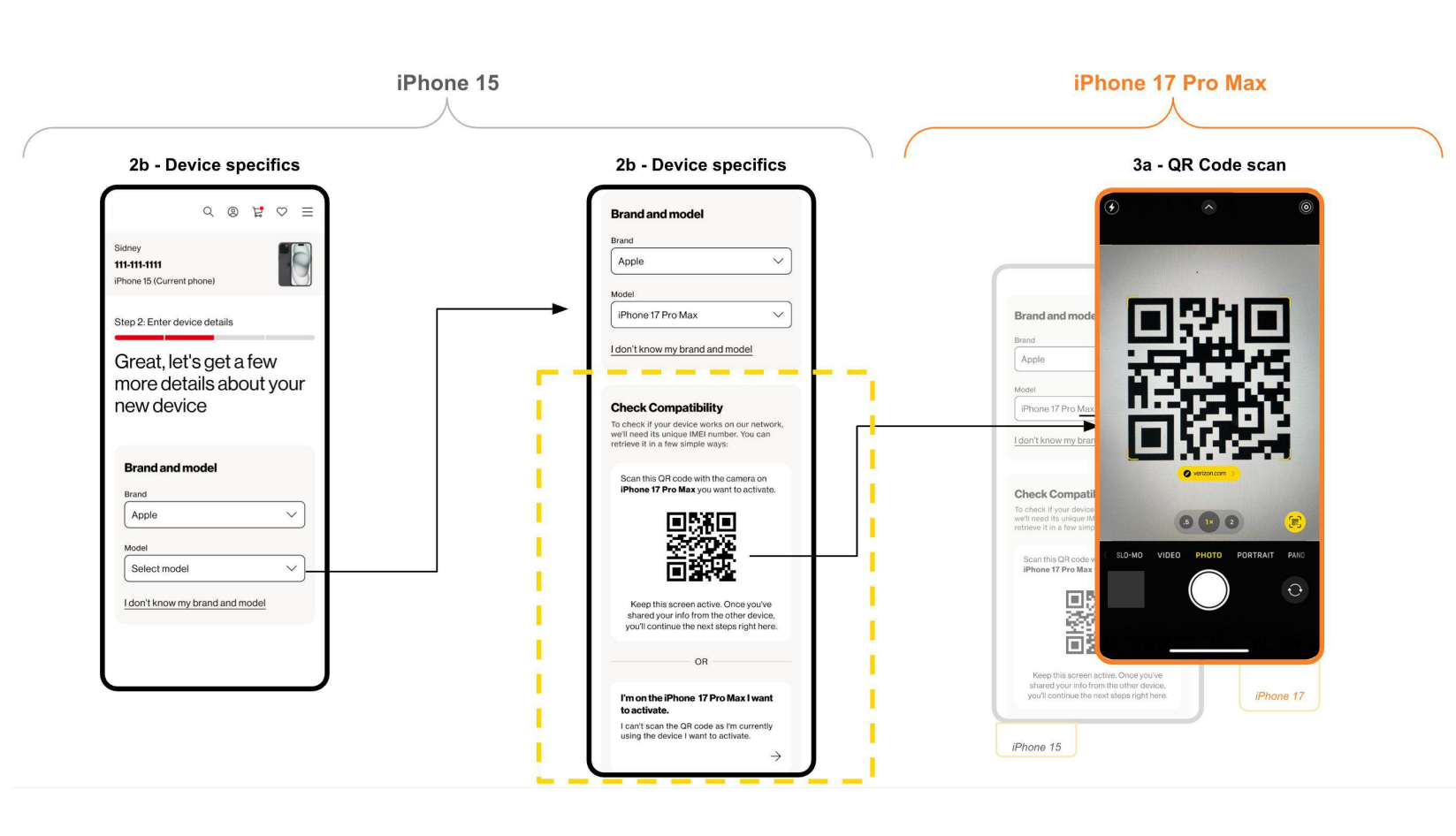

Global Navigation
Verizon Search
Account dashboard
Verizon Support
And more…
Let's find the right way to activate your device
Do you want to activate your new phone?
You recently had trouble activating your new phone. Do you want to try activating it now?
Do you want to activate your new replacement phone?
You recently deleted an eSIM. Do you want to reactivate it?
And more….

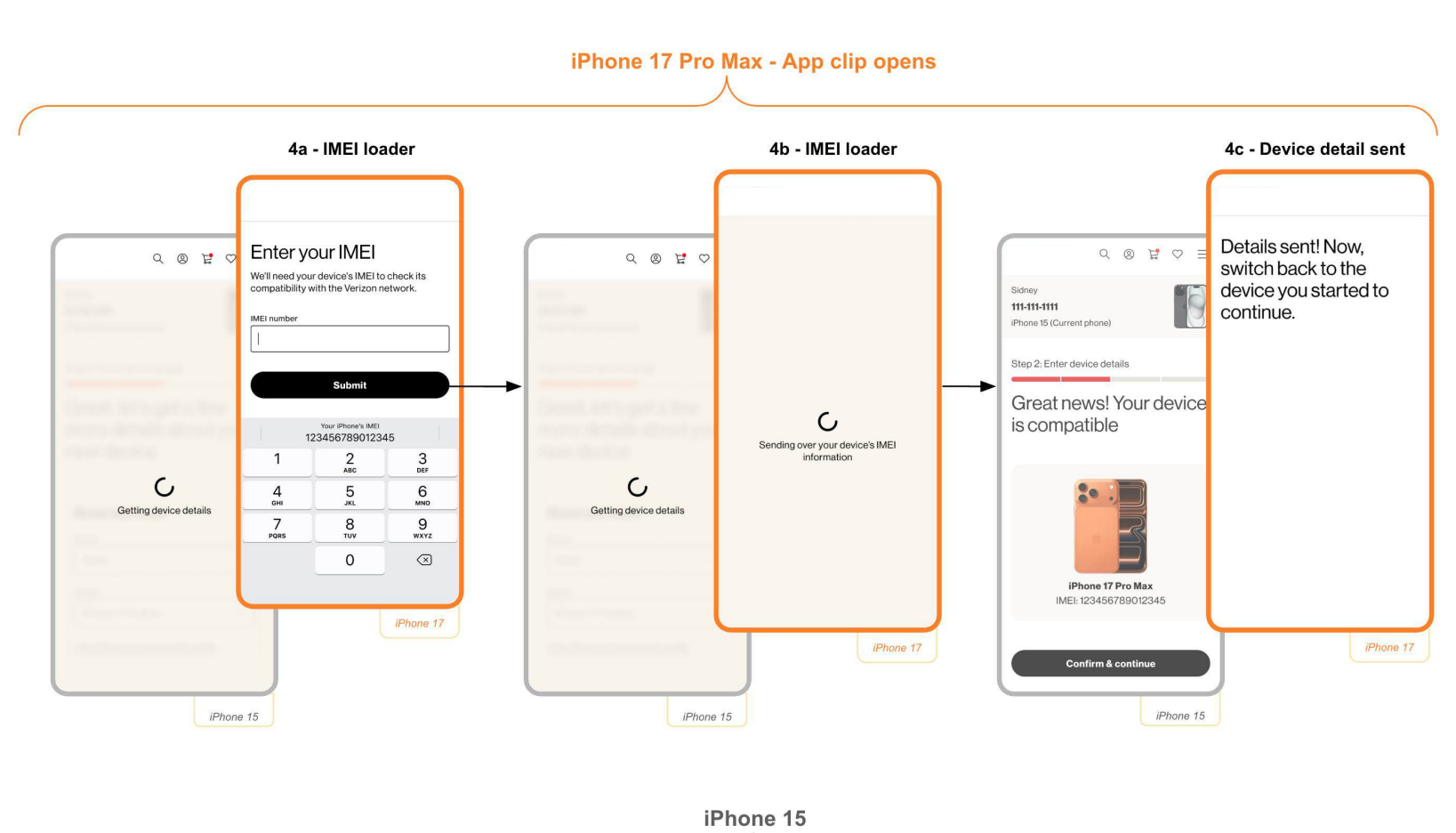
Proposed | Quick Activation (BYOD)

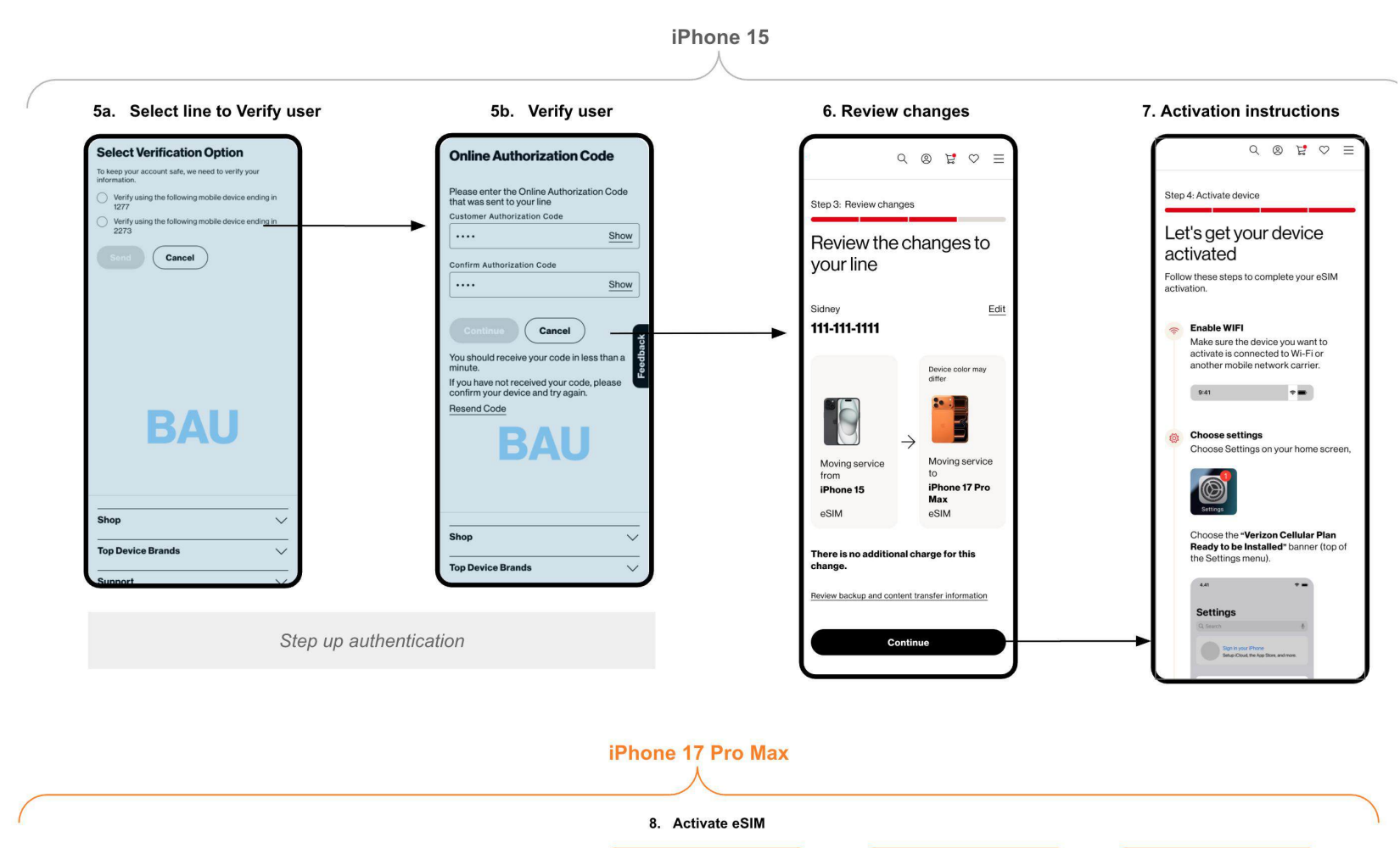
Scenario: "I'd like to activate the iPhone 17 Pro Max, brought from Apple store, on my current line."

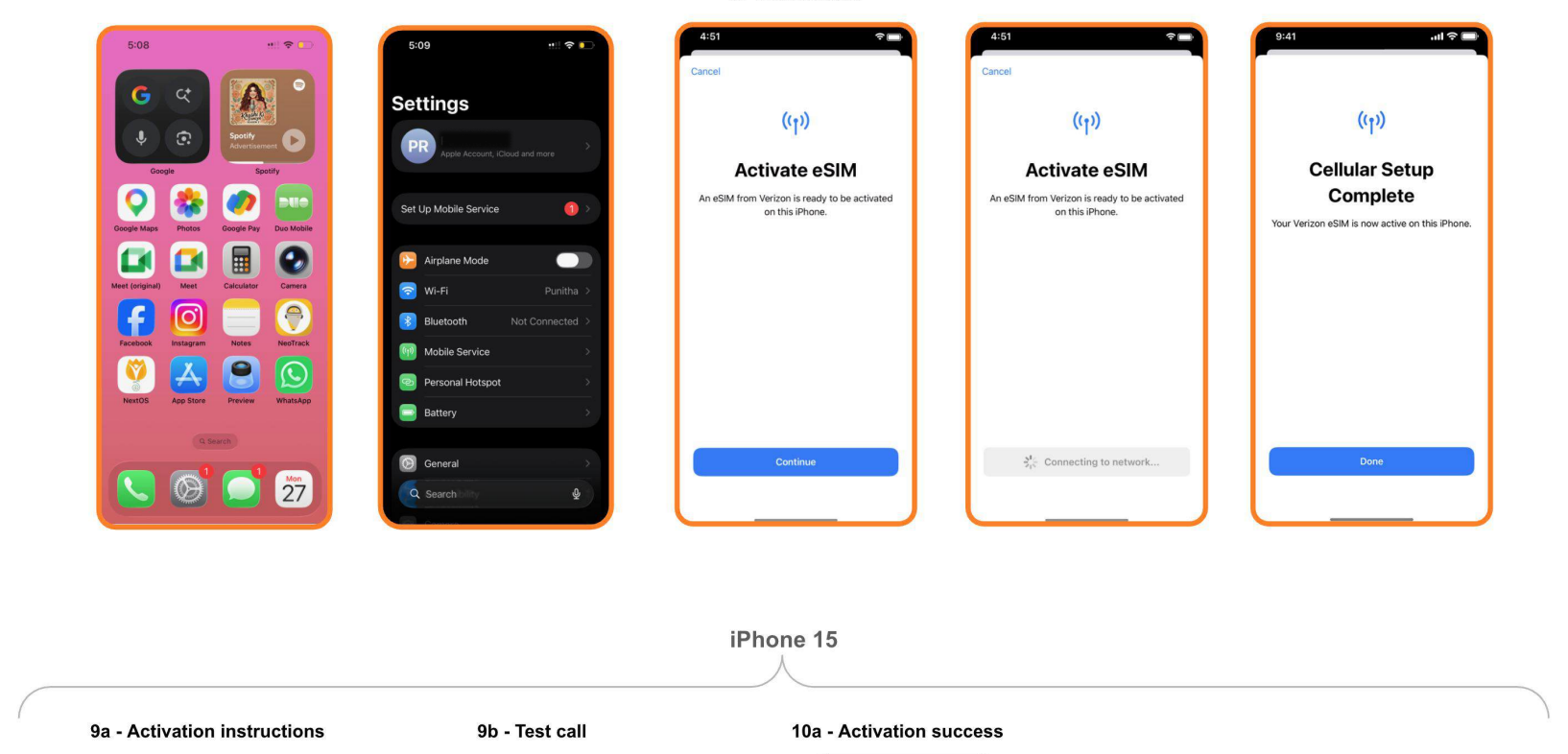
(Using different device to browse)

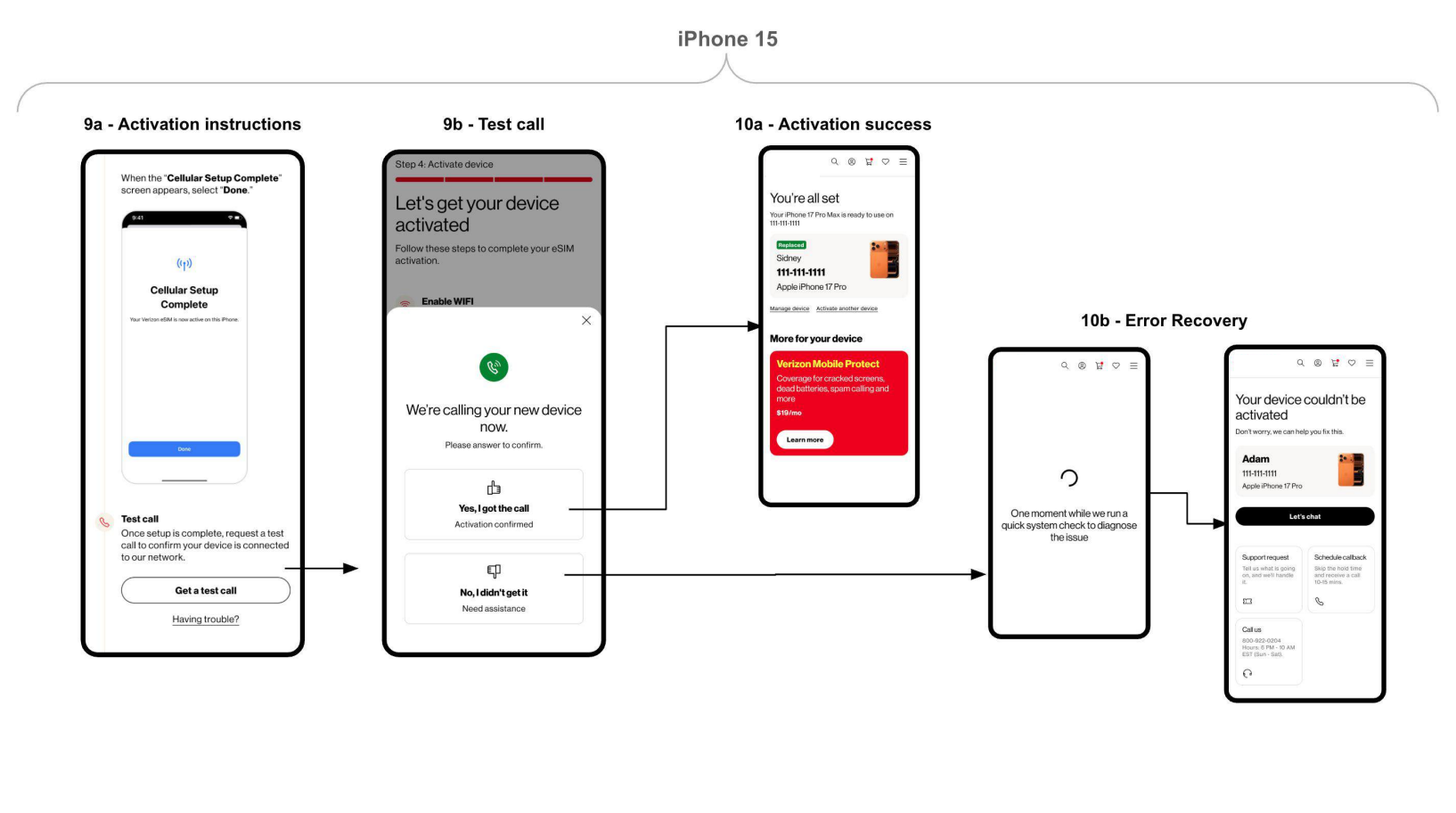

iPhone 15
Global Navigation
Verizon Search
Account dashboard
Verizon Support
And more…
Device activation Intent
1. Select line
2a. New/Previously used device
2b. Device specifics
Let's find the right way to activate your device
Select the line you want to activate the device on
Tell us about the device you're activating
Great, let's get a few more details about your new device


iPhone 15
iPhone 17 Pro Max
2b - Device specifics
3a - QR Code scan
Great, let's get a few more details about your new device
Brand and model
Check Compatibility


iPhone 17 Pro Max - App clip opens
4a - IMEI loader
4b - IMEI loader
4c - Device detail sent
Enter your IMEI
Submit
Getting device details
Details sent! Now, switch back to the device you started to continue.
Great news! Your device is compatible
Confirm & continue


iPhone 15
5a. Select line to Verify user
5b. Verify user
6. Review changes
7. Activation instructions
Select Verification Option
Online Authorization Code
BAU
Step up authentication
Review the changes to your line
Let's get your device activated
Continue


iPhone 17 Pro Max
8. Activate eSIM
Settings
Activate eSIM
Cellular Setup Complete


iPhone 15
9a - Activation instructions
9b - Test call
10a - Activation success
10b - Error Recovery
Cellular Setup Complete
Let's get your device activated
We're calling your new device now.
You're all set
Your device couldn't be activated

Outcome

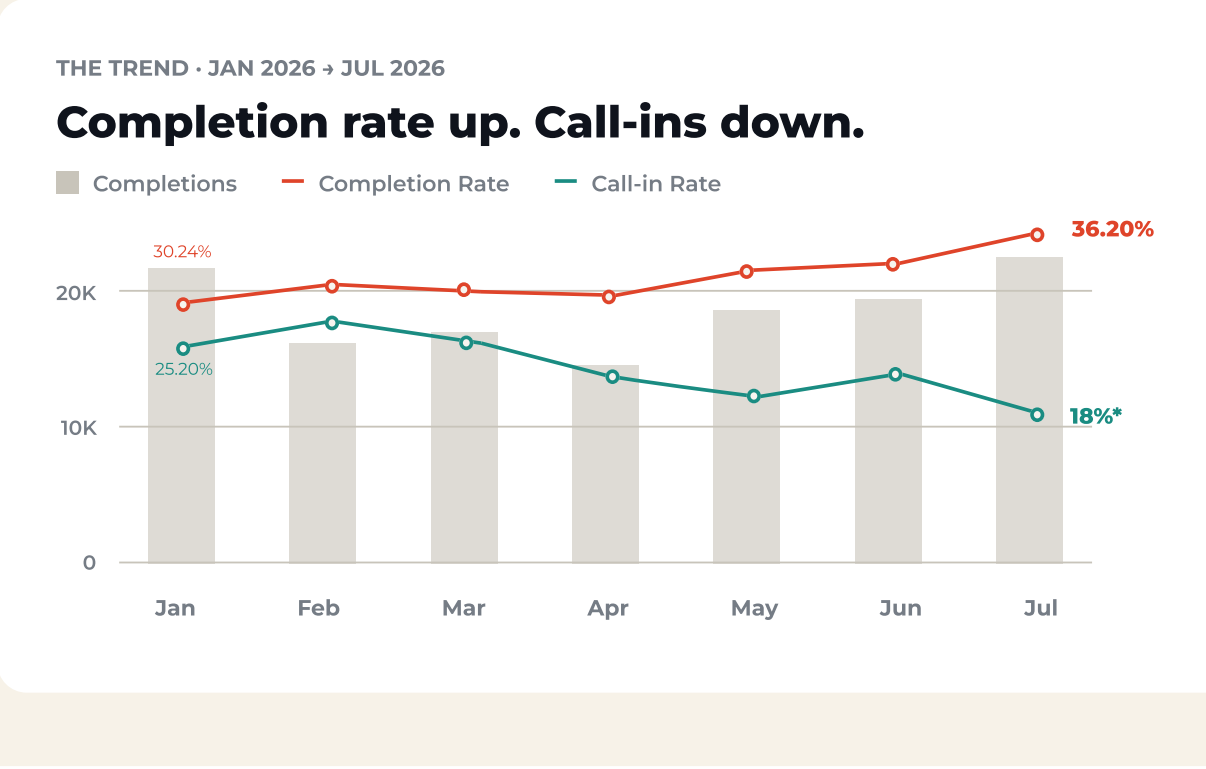
By focusing on user-centric design and seamless integration, we delivered an enhanced commerce experience that reduced friction and empowered activation journey.

The streamlined interfaces and intuitive navigation fostered user engagement, while the cohesive visual language elevated quick activation with Activation hub page. Ultimately, our efforts led to increased quick activation seamless without any frication.

TOTAL COMPLETIONS · JAN-JUL	COMPLETION RATE · JUL	CALL-IN RATE · JUL*
130,225	**36.2%**	**18%**
7-MONTH VOLUME	▲ +5.96 PTS VS JAN	▼ -7.20 PTS VS JAN

THE TREND · JAN 2026 → JUL 2026

Completion rate up. Call-ins down.



Thank you for viewing